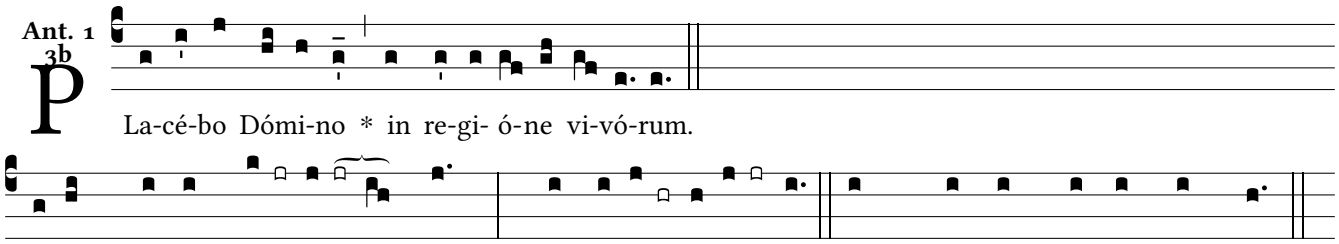
Vespers of the Dead LECTIONARY

Before Vespers

The following three Psalms were traditionally part of Vespers of the Dead, but were removed from the current edition. Hence, we will instead sing them before Vespers begins.

Psalm 116a [114]



for he turned **his** ear **to** me *
in the **day** when I **called** him.

They surrounded me, **the** snares **of** death, *
with the angu**ish** of **the** tomb;
they caught me, **sor**row and **dis**tress. *
I called **on** the **Lord's** name.

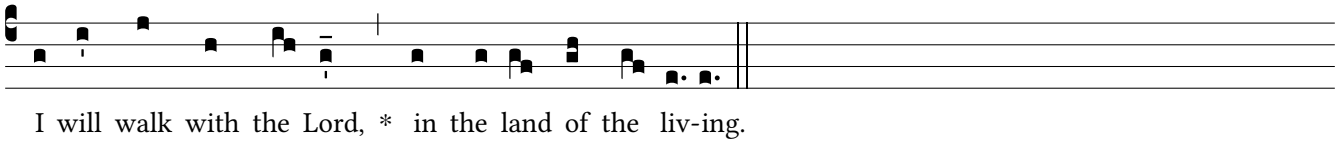
O Lord, my **God**, deli**ver** me!

How gracious is **the** Lord, **and** just; *
our God **has** com**pass**ion.
The Lord pro**tects** the **sim-ple** hearts; *
I was helpless **so** he **saved** me.

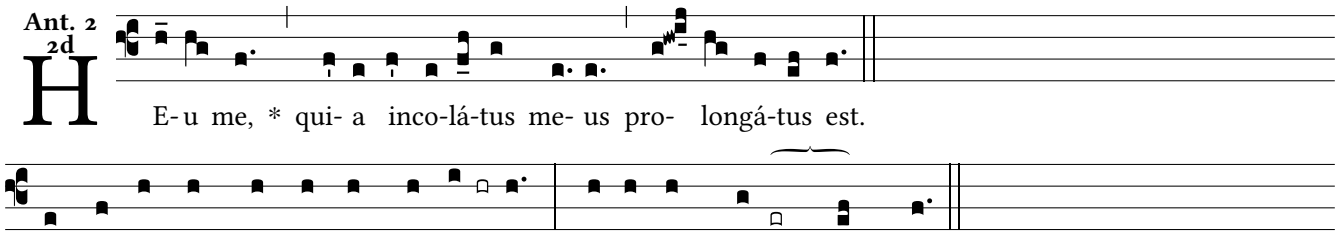
Turn back, my **soul**, to **your** rest *
for the **Lord** has **been** good;
he has kept my soul from death, †
my eyes **from** tears *
and my **feet** from **stum**bling.

I will walk in the **pre**sence of **the** Lord *
in the **land** of the **liv**ing.

Gloria **Pa**tri, et **Fi**lio, * et Spi**ri**tui **San**cto.
Sicut erat in principio, et **nunc**, et **sem**per, *
et in saecula saecu**lor**um. **A**men.



Psalm 120[119]



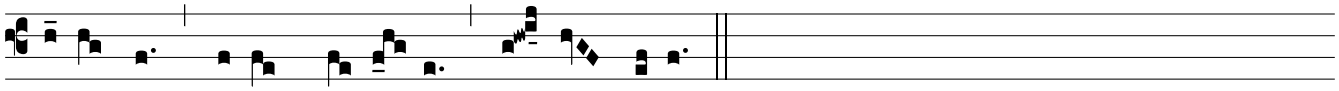
"O Lord, save my soul from **ly**ing lips, *
from the tongue of the *de***ceit**ful."

What shall he pay you in **re**turn, *
O *trea***cherous** tongue?
The warrior's arrows **shar**pened *
and coals, red-*hot*, **blaz**ing.

Alas, that I abide a stranger in **Mesh**ech, *
dwell among the tents *of* **Ke**dar!

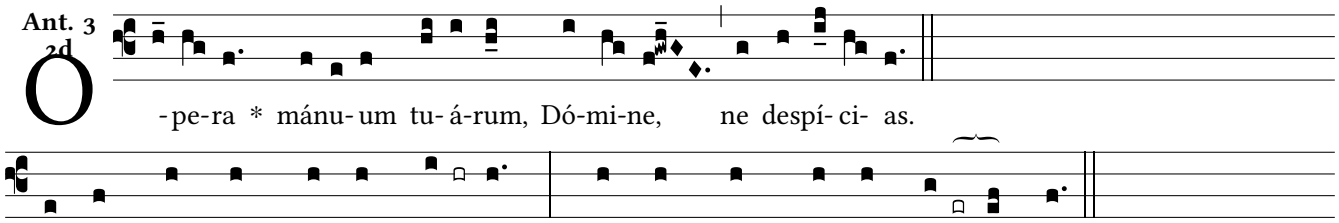
Long enough have I been **dwel**ling *
with those *who* **hate** peace.
I am for peace, but when **I** speak, *
they are *for* **fight**ing.

Gloria Patri, et **Fi**lio, * et Spiritu*i* **San**cto.
Sicut erat in principio, et nunc, et **sem**per, *
et in saecula saeculo*rum.* **A**men.



Woe is me, * because my so- journ has been pro-longed.

Psalm 138[137]



I thank you, Lord, with all **my** heart, * you have heard the words *of* **my** mouth.

In the presence of the angels I will **bless** you. *
I will adore before your ho*ly* **tem**ple.

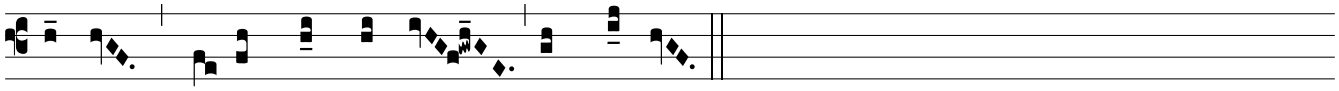
I thank you for your faithfulness **and** love *
which excel all we ev*er* **knew of** you.
On the day I called, you **an**swered; *
you increased the strength *of* **my** soul.

All earth's kings shall **thank** you *
when they hear the words *of* **your** mouth.
They shall sing of the **Lord's** ways: *
"How great is the glory *of* **the** Lord!"

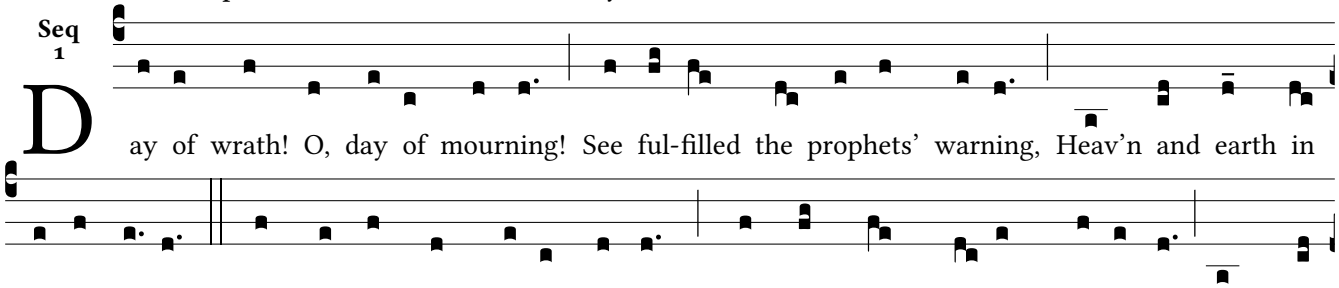
The Lord is high yet he looks on the **low**ly *
and the haughty he knows *from* **a**far.
Though I walk in the midst of af**flic**tion *
you give me life and frust*rate* **my** foes.

You stretch out your hand and **save** me, *
your hand will do *all* **things for** me.
Your love, O Lord, is e**ter**nal, *
discard not the work *of* **your** hands.

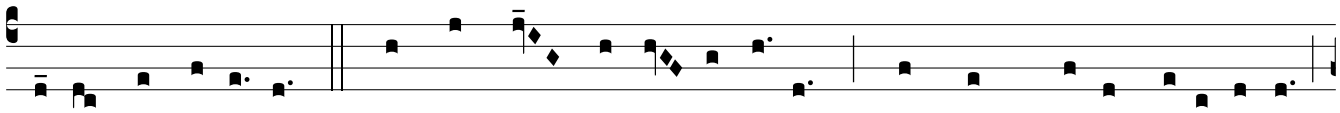
Gloria Patri, et **Fi**lio, * et Spiritu*i* **San**cto.
Sicut erat in principio, et nunc, et **sem**per, *
et in saecula saeculo*rum.* **A**men.



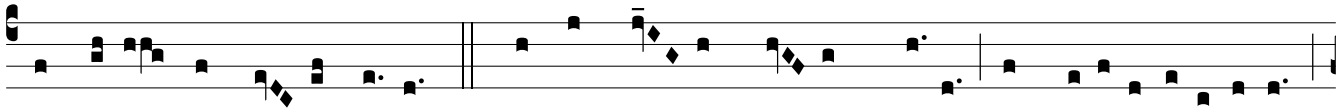
O Lord, * despise not the works of Thy hands.



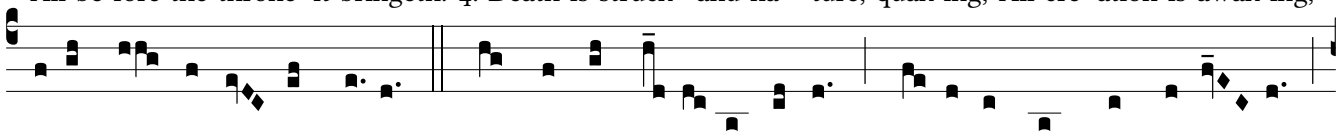
ashes burning! 2. O what fear man's bos-om rendeth, When from heav'n the Judge descendeth, On whose



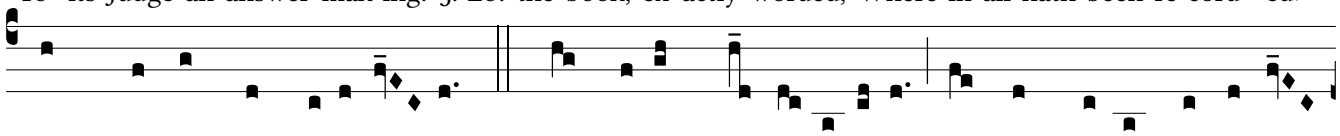
sentence all de-pendeth! 3. Wondrous sound the trum-pet flingeth; Through earth's sep-ulchres it ringeth;



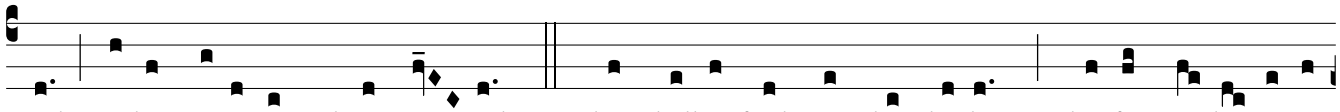
All be-fore the throne it bringeth. 4. Death is struck and na- ture, quak-ing, All cre- ation is awak-ing,



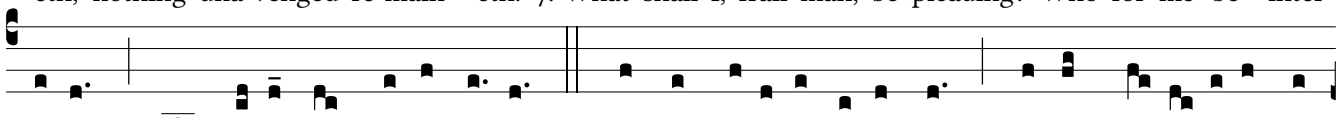
To its Judge an answer mak-ing. 5. Lo! the book, ex- actly worded, Where-in all hath been re-cord- ed:



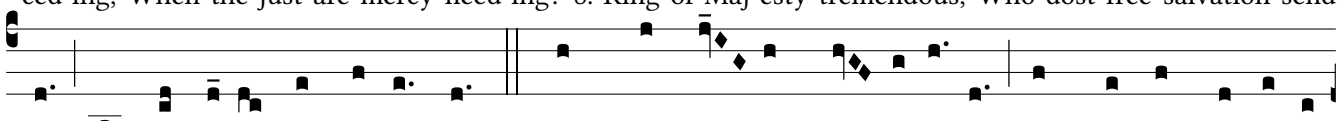
Thence shall judgment be award- ed. 6. When the Judge his seat attaineth, And each hidden deed arraign-



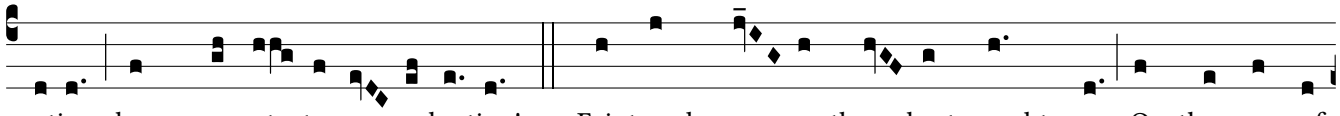
eth, nothing una-venged re-main- eth. 7. What shall I, frail man, be pleading? Who for me be inter-



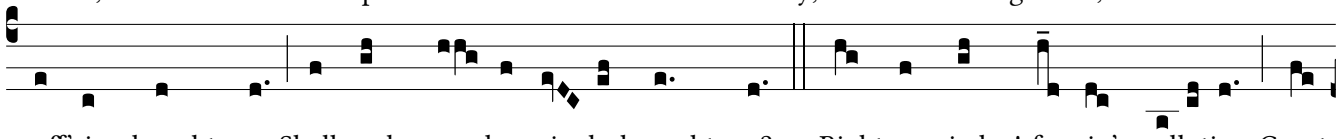
ced-ing, When the just are mercy need-ing? 8. King of Maj-esty tremendous, Who dost free salvation send



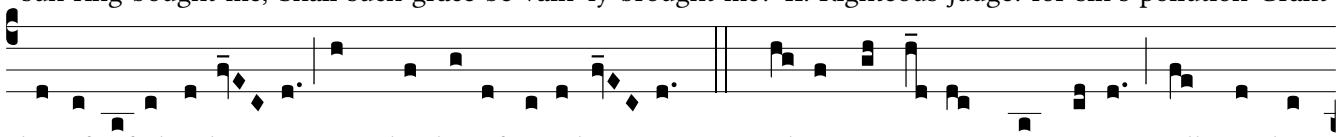
us, fount of pit-y, then befriend us! 9. Think, good Je- sus, my salva-tion Cost thy wondrous Incar-



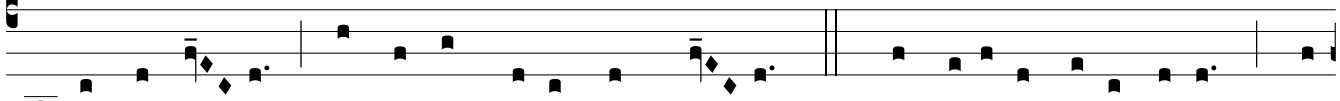
nation; leave me not to rep- ro-ba-tion! 10. Faint and wea- ry, thou hast sought me, On the cross of



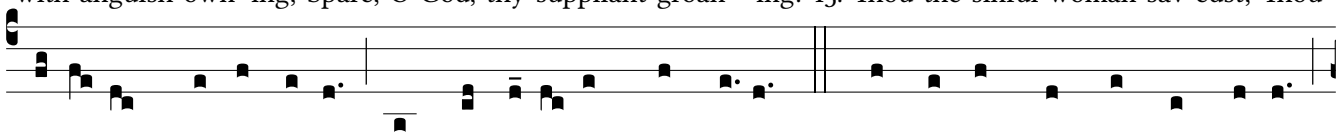
suff'ring bought me, Shall such grace be vain- ly brought me? 11. Righteous judge! for sin's pollution Grant



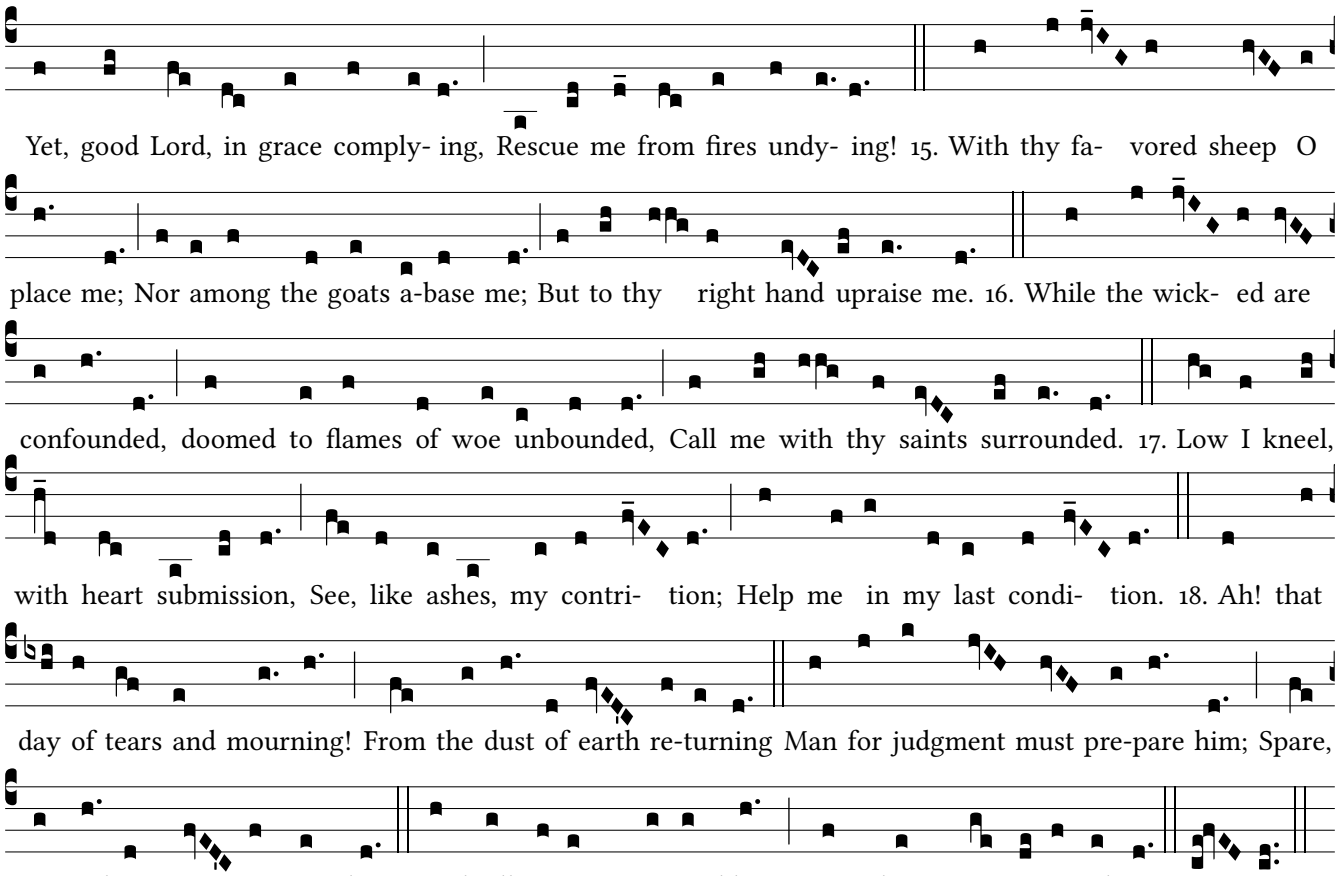
thy gift of abso-lu- tion, Ere the day of retri-bu- tion. 12. Guilt-y, now I pour my moaning, All my shame



with anguish own- ing; Spare, O God, thy suppliant groan- ing! 13. Thou the sinful woman sav-edst; Thou

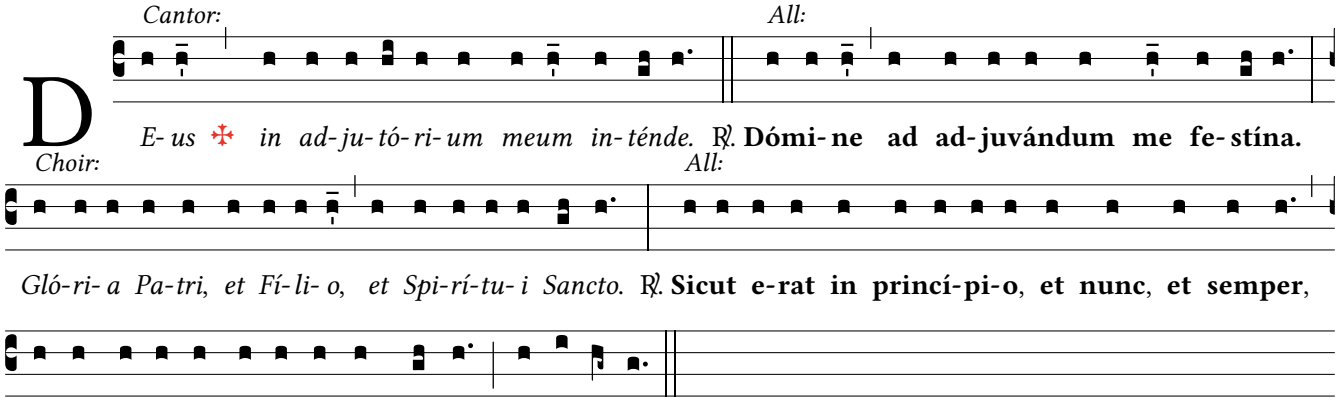


the dy- ing thief for-ga-vedst; And to me a hope vouchsa-fest. 14. Worthless are my prayers and sighing,



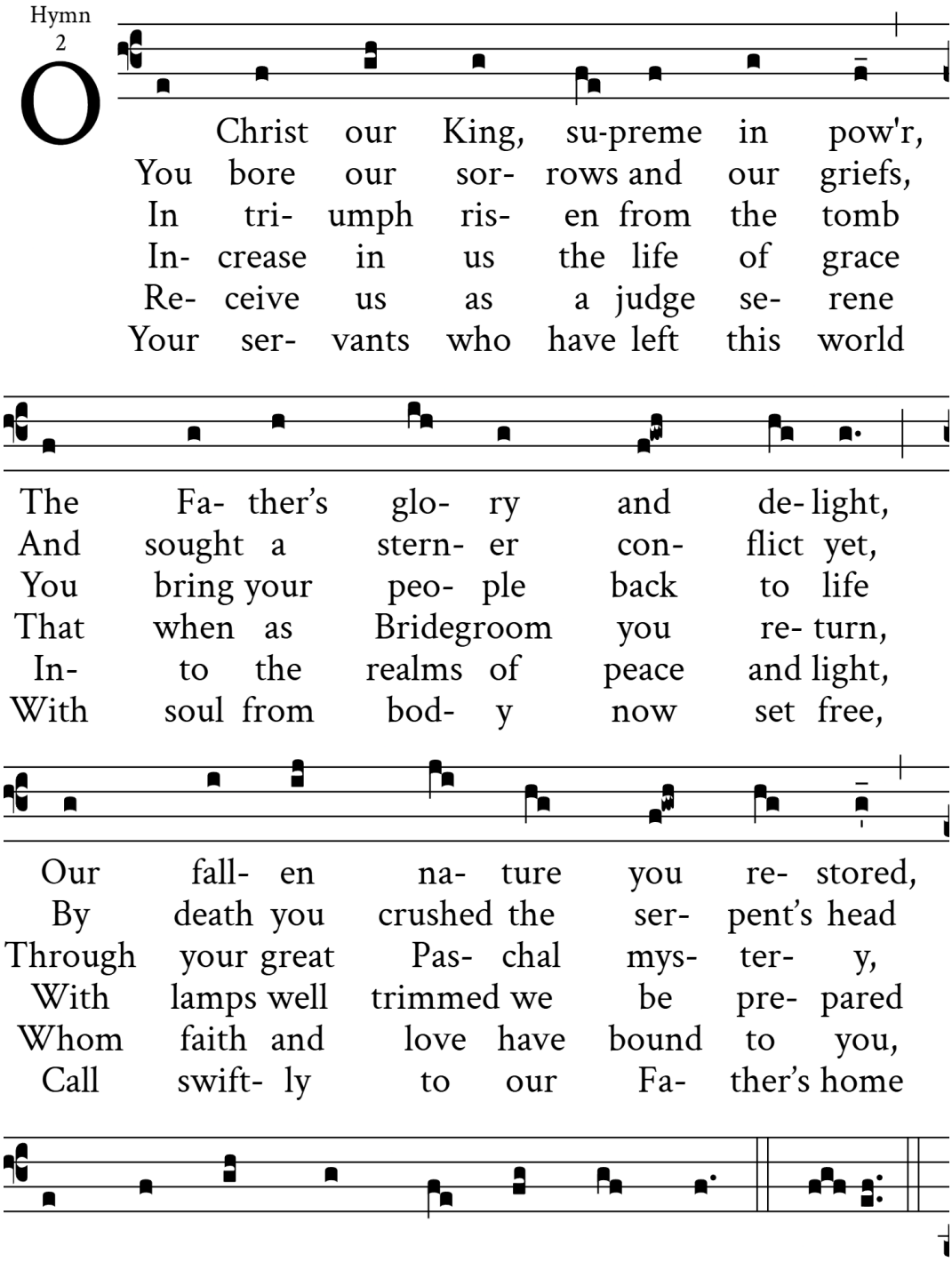
At Vespers

Stand



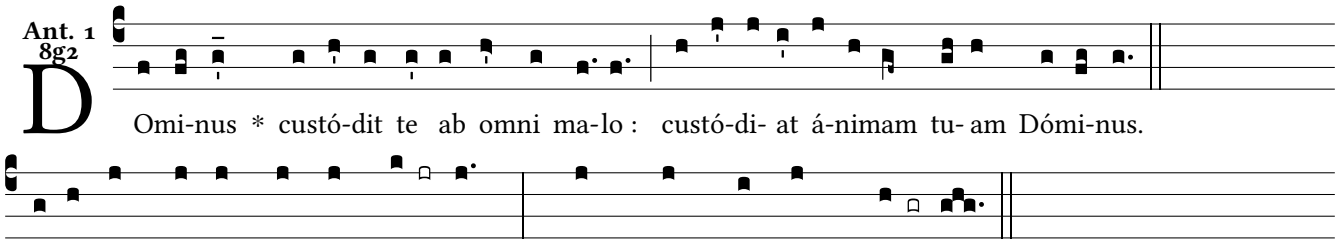
Anon.; Tr: © the Benedictines of Saint Cecilia's Abbey, Ryde, UK

Hymn
2



Sit

Psalm 121[120]



I lift up my eyes to the **moun**-tains: * from where *shall come* **my** help?

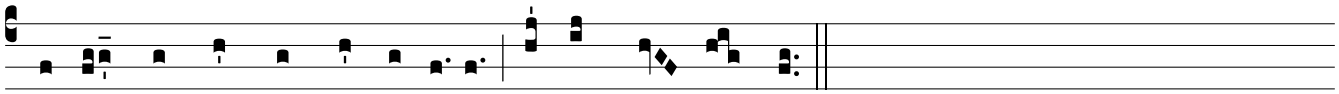
My help shall come from **the** Lord *
who made *hea*ven **and** earth.

May he never allow you to **stum**ble! *
Let him *sleep* not, **your** guard.
No, he sleeps not nor **slum**bers, *
Is-ra-**el's** guard.

The Lord is your guard and **your** shade; *
at your *right* side **he** stands.
By day the sun shall not **smite** you *
nor the *moon* in **the** night.

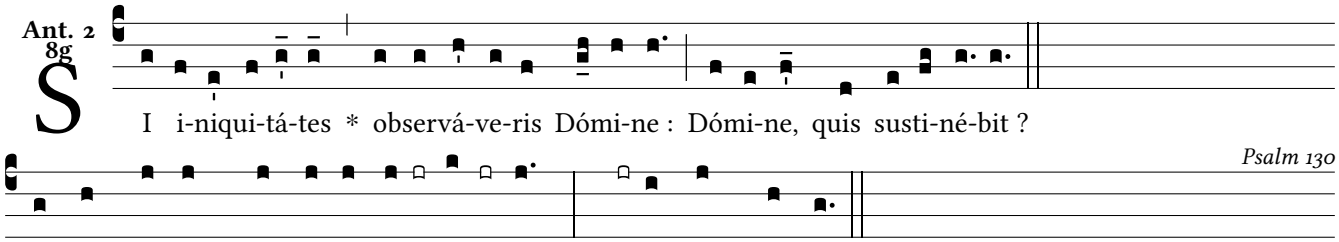
The Lord will guard you from **e**vil, *
he *will* guard **your** soul.
The Lord will guard your going and **com**ing *
both now *and* for **e**ver.

Gloria Patri, et **Fi**lio, * et Spiri*tu*i **San**cto.
Sicut erat in principio, et nunc, et **sem**per, *
et in saecula saecu*lor*um. **A**men.



The Lord will keep you from all e-vil. He will guard your soul.

Psalm 130[129]



Out of the depths I cry to you, **O** Lord: * *Lord,* hear **my** voice!

O let your ears be at**ten**tive *
to the voice *of* my **plea**ding.

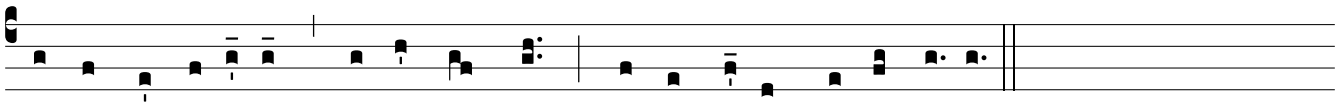
If you, O Lord, should mark **our** guilt, *
Lord, *who* would **sur**vive?
But with you is found for**give**ness: *
for this *we* re**vere** you.

My soul is waiting for **the** Lord, *
I *count* on **his** word.
My soul is longing for **the** Lord *
more than watch*man* for **day**break.

Let the watchman count on **day**break *
and Isr*ael* on **the** Lord.

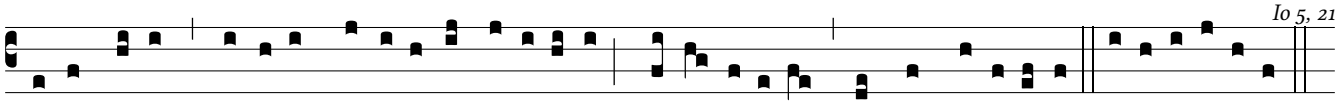
Because with the Lord there is **mer**cy *
and fullness *of* re**dem**ption,
Israel indeed he will **re**deem *
from all *its* i**ni**quity.

Gloria Patri, et **Fi**lio, * et Spiri*tu*i **San**cto.
Sicut erat in principio, et nunc, et **sem**per, *
et in saecula saecu*lor*um. **A**men.

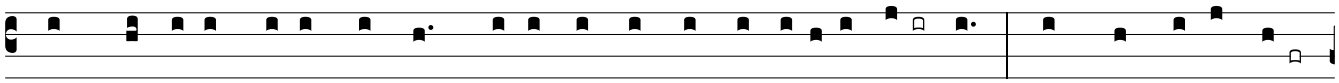


If you kept a re-cord * of our sins, Lord, who could escape condemna-tion?

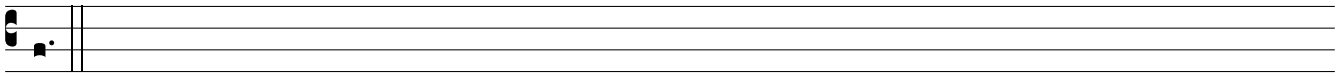
Canticle: Philippians 2:6-11



SI-cut Pa-ter * súsci-tat mórtu- os et vi-ví- fi-cat, sic et Fí- li- us quos vult vi-ví- fi-cat. E u o u a e.



Though he was in the form of God, † Je-sus did not deem equa-*li-ty* **with** God * some*thing to be* **grasped**



at.

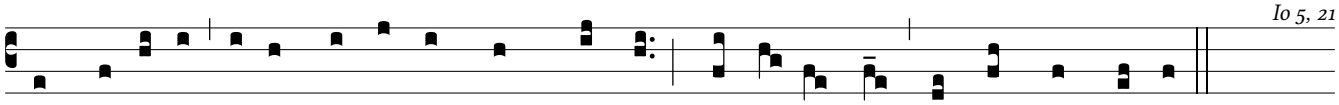
Rather, he emptied himself †
and took the *form* of **a** slave, *
being born in *the* likeness **of** men.

He was known to be of *hu*man **es**tate, *
and it was thus that *he* humbled **him**self,
obediently accep*ting* ev**en** death, *
death **on** a cross!

Because **of** this, *
God high*ly* exalt**ed** him
and bestowed *on* him **the** name *
above *ev*'ry o**ther** name,

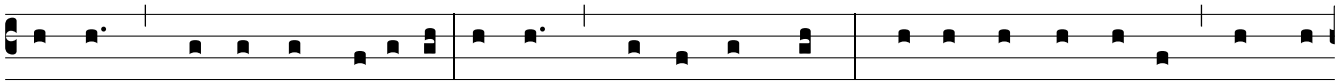
So that *at* Jes**us'** name *
ev'ry knee **must** bend
in the heav*ens*, on **the** earth, *
and under **the** earth,
and every tongue proclaim †
to the glory of *God* the **Fa**ther: *
JESUS CHRIST **IS** LORD!

Gloria Pat*ri*, et **Fi**lio, * et Spi*ri*tui **San**cto.
Sicut erat in principio, et *nunc*, et **sem**per, *
et in saecula sae*cu*lorum. **A**men.



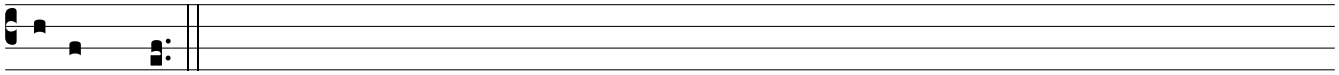
As the Father rais-es the dead and gives them life, so the Son gives life to whom he wills.

Reading: 1 Corinthians 15:55-57



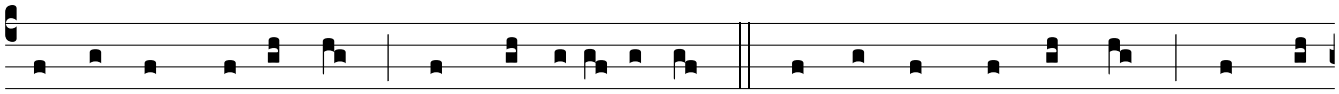
O death, where is your victo-ry? O death, where is your sting? The sting of death is sin, † and sin

gets its power from the law. But thanks be to God who has giv-en us the victo-ry through our Lord

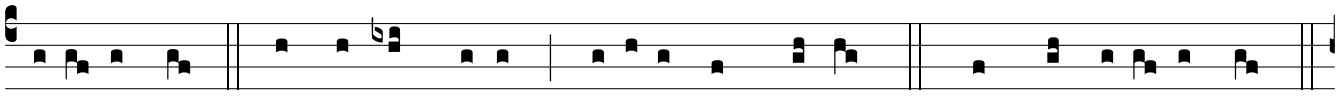


Je-sus Christ.

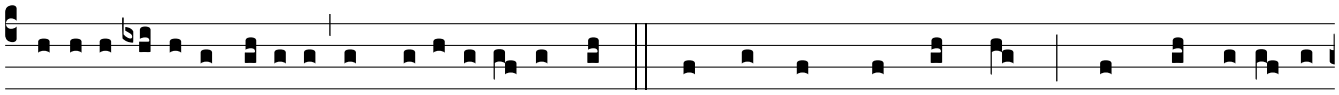
Responsory



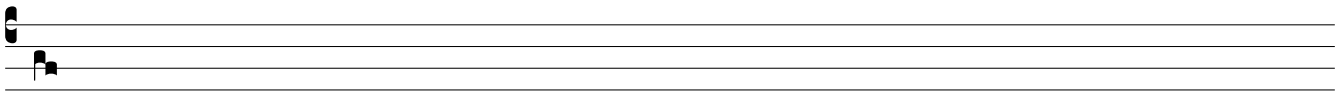
Lord, in your steadfast love, * give them e-ternal rest. ℟. **Lord, in your steadfast love, * give them**



e-ternal rest. ℣. You will come to judge the liv-ing and the dead. ℟. * **give them e-ternal rest.** ℣.



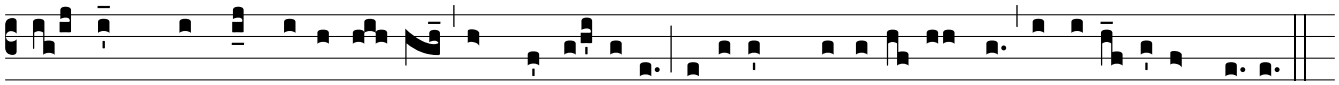
Gló-ri- a Patri et Fí- li- o et Spi-rí-tu- i Sancto. ℟. **Lord, in your steadfast love, * give them e-ternal**



rest.

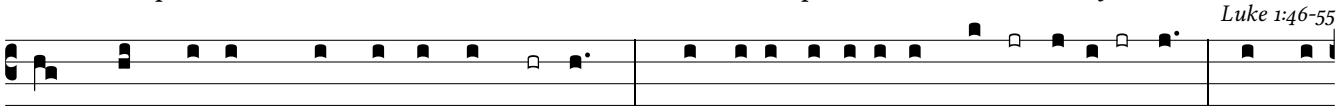
Gospel Canticle

Stand

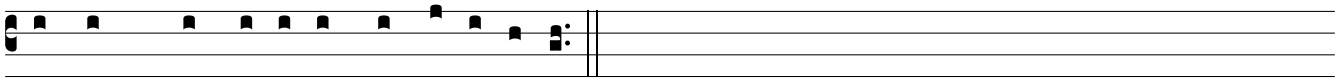


O-mne * quod dat mi-hi Pa- ter, ad me vé- ni- et : et e- um qui ve-nit ad me, non e- jí- ci- am fo-ras.

Luke 1:46-55



My ✠ soul proclaims the greatness of the Lord: † my spi-rit re-joices in **God** my **sa-** vior: * for He



has looked with fa-vor on His **low**ly **ser**vant.

From this day all generations will call me blessed: †
the Almighty has done **great** things **for** me, *
and **ho**ly is **his** Name.

He has mercy on **those** who **fear** him *
in every **gene**ration.

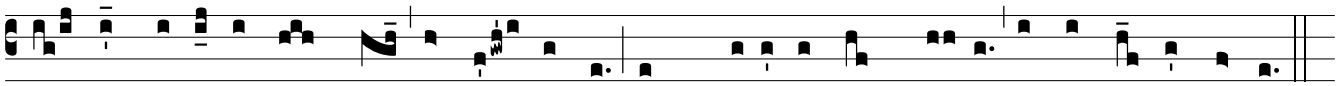
He has shown the **strength** of **his** arm, *
he has scattered the **proud** in their **con**ceit.

He has cast down the **migh**ty from **their** thrones, *
and has lifted **up** the **low**ly.

He has filled the **hun**gry with **good** things, *
and the rich he has **sent** away **emp**ty.

He has come to the help of his **ser**vant Is-**ra**-el *
for he has remembered his **pro**mise of **me**rcy,
the promise he **made** to our **fa**thers, *
to Abraham and his **chil**dren for **ev**er.

Gloria **Pa**tri, et **Fi**lio, * et Spi**ri**tui **San**cto.
Sicut erat in principio, et **nunc**, et **sem**per, *
et in saecula saecu**lor**um. **A**men.



All that the Father gives me will come to me, and who- ev-er comes to me I shall not turn away.

Intercessions

Recto tono.

We acknowledge Christ the Lord through whom we hope that our lowly bodies will be made like his in glory, and we say: **Lord, you are our life and resurrection.**

Christ, Son of the living God, who raised up Lazarus, your friend, from the dead,
– raise up to life and glory the dead whom you have redeemed by your precious blood.
Lord, you are our life and resurrection.

Christ, consoler of those who mourn, you dried the tears of the family of Lazarus, of the widow's son, and the daughter of Jairus,
– comfort those who mourn for the dead.
Lord, you are our life and resurrection.

Christ, Savior, destroy the reign of sin in our earthly bodies, so that just as through sin we deserved punishment,
– so through you we may gain eternal life.
Lord, you are our life and resurrection.

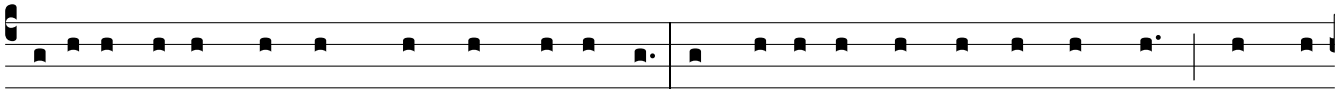
Christ, Redeemer, look on those who have no hope because they do not know you,
– may they receive faith in the resurrection and in the life of the world to come.
Lord, you are our life and resurrection.

You revealed yourself to the blind man who begged for the light of his eyes,
– show your face to the dead who are still deprived of your light.
Lord, you are our life and resurrection.

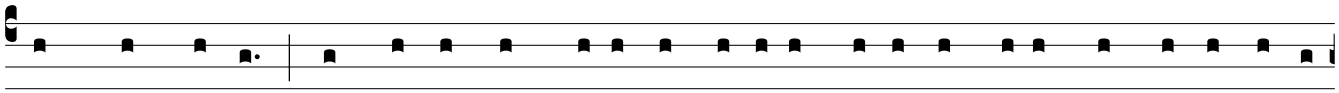
When at last our earthly home is dissolved,
– give us a home, not of earthly making, but built of eternity in heaven.
Lord, you are our life and resurrection.

Our Father - recto tono

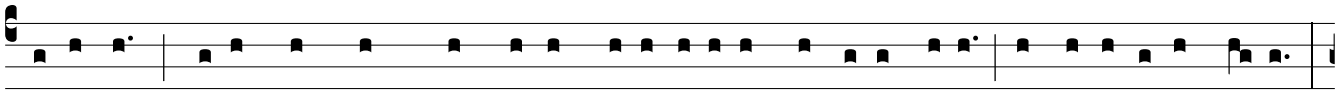
Prayer & Dismissal



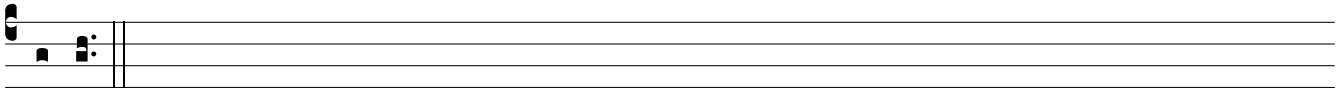
Merci-ful Father, hear our prayers and console us. As we re-new our faith in your Son, whom you



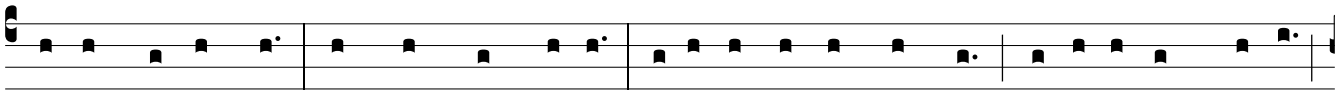
raised from the dead, strengthen our hope that all our de-parted brothers and sisters will share in his res-



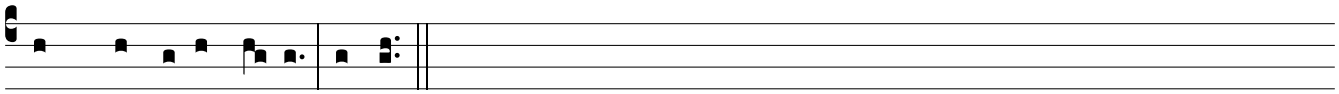
urrection, who lives and reigns with you in the u-ni-ty of the Ho-ly Spir-it, God for ev-er and ev-er.



– Amen.



The Lord be with you. **And with your spirit.** May almighty God bless you, the Father, and the Son,



and the Ho-ly Spir-it. **Amen.**